Greater Tuna

By Jaston Williams, Joe Sears and Ed Howard

NOTE: This play was designed for 2 actors to play all the characters. This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles:

ACTOR 1: *Thurston, Arles 2, Bertha, Vera, Leonard*
ACTOR 2: *Arles, Thurston 2, Didi, Chad, Elmer, Coach*

THURSTON: **(Pg 9-10)** *(Opening music)* Good morning, Tuna, this is Thurston Wheelis.

ARLES: And this is Arles Struvie,

THURSTON: And this is the Wheelis

ARLES: Struvie-

THURSTON: Report.

ARLES: And here we go with the news. Take it away, Thurston.

THURSTON: Well, folks, in the news today, we've got the winner of the Tuna Junior High American Heritage Essay Contest for this year. And this year's winner is Connie Carp. She's the daughter of W.H. and Vera Carp here in Tuna, and the name of her essay was titled "Human Rights, Why Bother?"

THURSTON 2: Second place went to Jimbo Beaumont for "Living with Radiation", and third place went to Levita Posey for her essay titled, "The Other Side of Bigotry."

THURSTON: I'll tell you, Aries, with subjects like that, I don't know how they ever picked a winner.

ARLES: I don't either. I tell you, it should make the citizens of Tuna proud to know that we're still producing well-educated students who know what America is all about.

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INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *Welcome to Tuna, the third-smallest town in Texas, "where the Lions Club is too liberal, and Patsy Cline never died."*
ACTOR 2: *The play originated nearly 40 years ago as a Texas party skit based on a political cartoon; but frighteningly enough, it still rings true today!*
ACTOR 1: *So with no further ado . . . Here are our radio hosts, Arles Struvie and Thurston Wheelis!*
TOGETHER: *Greater Tuna by Jaston Williams, Joe Sears and Ed Howard*

ARLES: **(Pg 10-12)** Now, on the Art scene, the on-again, off-again auditions for the Tuna Little Theatre production of "My Fair Lady" are on again. Now, they'd been called off due to a lack of budget. But Joe Bob Lipsey, who is the director of the show this year, said that he found a way to go ahead with the production by using sets and costumes from last year's show of "South Pacific."

ARLES 2: According to Joe Bob, this is gonna be the first production ever of "My Fair Lady" set in Polynesia. So get on your Hawaiian shirts, and your grass skirts, and your coconuts, and get out there to that Coweta Baptist Church at eight-thirty, Thursday night, and audition for "My Fair Lady."

ARLES: Joe Bob says he wants to integrate the cast this year. So if you know of any Negro or Mexican-American actors or actresses, have 'em come on out and try out for the chorus.

THURSTON: Well, folks, it's time for a word from our sponsor, Didi Snavely of Didi's Used Weapons. And here's Didi now to tell us all about it. Didi. *(Musical transition)*

DIDI: Does the high cost of security have you blue? If so, come by the store and browse through our complete selection of used guns and knives, or find what you need in our mace and tear gas department. Now we understand that many people are hesitant to buy used weapons, but all of Didi's weapons are absolutely guaranteed to kill. Now if you find a weapon here that won't kill, you bring it back and we'll give you something that will. It's on our guarantee: "If Didi's can't kill it, it's immortal."

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ARLES: **(Pg 13)** And from our World News Desk: Peace talks fail, attack is imminent. Well,

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that's all the news we got for ya, but stay tuned . . .

CHAD: **(Pg 20-22)** My name is Chad Hartford [Reporter for Intellect Magazine. Let's get right to our interview] Now, Mrs. Bumiller, you are chairing the Censorship of the Textbooks Committee, am I correct?

BERTHA: Oh, no no no no. The Reverend Spikes heads that committee . . . although I am a member, I head the subcommittee that wants to snatch the books off the shelves of the high school library. Some of those books are absolutely disgusting. Our children have no business reading them, and somebody has got to protect the minds of the children.

CHAD: Now, exactly what are the books that you think should be removed from the shelves?

BERTHA: Well, now there's four of 'em that we're gonna try and have removed nationwide. And then we're gonna go from there. *Roots.* Now, we don't deny that *Roots* has been a very popular TV series, but we feel it only shows one side of the slavery issue. *Bury My Heart at Wounded Knee.* Well, it's the most disgusting title to begin with; it just makes me want to erp. It vilifies a great American, General Custer. And it encourages the reader to believe that the United States Government can't be trusted in makin' any treaties. *Huckleberry Finn,* by Mark Twain. Now, that book shows a pre-teenage boy avoidin' his chores, runnin' away from home, cohortin' with a Negro convict, and puttin' on women's clothes. [And] *Romeo and Juliet.* It shows sex among teenagers, and we're certainly not going to encourage it. Besides, it shows a rampant disrespect for parental authority.

CHAD: You are aware that William Shakespeare wrote that play?

BERTHA: Oh, yes, we are. And we're lookin' into the rest of his stuff too. He wrote *Barefoot in the Park,* didn't he?

CHAD: Thank you Mrs. Bumiller. I think we got one hell of a story here.

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ARLES: **(Pg 27-28)** And now folks, sit back and listen to the number one show in Dewey County. On the Line with Leonard. Where your business is everybody's business. Here's station manager Leonard Childers. *(Musical transition)*

LEONARD: Hello everybody. This is Leonard Childers with "This Week in Tuna." I got a

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message here from the Reverend Spikes over at the Coweta Baptist Church; he says he's gonna sponsor another record-burning. Bring all your rock-and-roll, and this time be sure and get your Chuck Berry and your Brenda Lee and your Little Richard. He says, leave that Buddy Holly and Elvis at home; they're good Southern boys and they'll be forgiven. Anyway, that'll be this comin' Sunday night at eight o'clock down at the Coweta Baptist Church. So bring your rock-and-roll, come on out and burn it . . .

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THURSTON: **(Pg 41)** *(Musical intro)* Good afternoon, Tuna. This is Thurston Wheelis, and this is the Wheelis-Struvie Midday Report. First off in the news, there's gonna be a meeting of the Smut Snatchers of the New Order this afternoon at the Coweta Baptist Church, startin' about five o'clock. Now, Radio Station OKKK is gonna carry that meetin' live. So you tune in.

THURSTON 2: Now, the Smut Snatchers' latest project is cleaning up those dictionaries down at Tuna High School. And they say, if you know of a word that you feel has questionable value, or a word that you feel just should not be in the dictionary- now if you don't want your child around the word, bring that word with you to the meeting.

THURSTON: Bring it to the meeting. The Reverend Spikes says he'll consider each word on a word-by-word basis.

ARLES: **(Pg 44)** And from our National News Desk: Nuclear accident imperils millions in seven states-Texas not included. Well, that's all the news we got for ya, but don't touch that dial-

THURSTON: Don't touch that dial . . . Get away from it!

ARLES: Get away from it! 'Cause Tuna Speaks is next! *(Musical transition)*

ELMER: **(Pg 45)** This is Elmer Watkins on Tuna Speaks. As a citizen of Tuna, I feel it's my obligation to speak up about this Agent Orange Stuff and its effects on servicemen. I just wanna say that in the last year I've hired fourteen veterans, Viet Nam veterans, to work for me on my road crew, and out of those fourteen, only four of 'em have died, but there wasn't a one of 'em turned orange. I swear to God, not one of 'em turned anyways near orange. I think it's just more of this propaganda by this liberal press and these hippie-oriented groups!

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VERA: **(Pg 46)** Vera Carp, Vice-President of the Smut Snatchers of the new Order . . . We need to send out our book-snatchin' squad to the Tuna High School Library to check those dictionaries. Now, we have a new list of words that have been declared possibly offensive or misunderstandable to pre-college students. Now the words are: hot, hooker, coke, clap, deflower, ball, knocker and nuts. After much prayer and soul-searching with the Lord, the Committee has decided **not** to include the word "snatch" on this year's list. We know some of you have very strong feelings about "snatch," but we just can't afford to change our letterhead at this time.

LEONARD: **(Pg 53)** This is Leonard Childers with the Tuna Bulletin Board. Now, if you have any younguns between the ages of eight and fourteen, you need to know that Thursday is your last day to register your kids for Colonel Sprayberry's Character Camp and Survival Institute. Now this year, they're offering classes in Old Testament appreciation, segregation in the Scriptures, Christian biology, character development, and the proper use of firearms. So register your kids today; it will do them some good.

THURSTON: **(Pg 49-50)** *(Musical transition)* This is Thurston Wheelis with a sports flash. This just in. The Tuna High School Jaguars lost their season opener against the Kuhlburg Comanches. It was a hard-fought contest, but in the end, the Cats were on the short end of a 48 to nothin' score. Coach Raymond Chassie evaluated the loss this way.

COACH: Well, we lost mainly because we couldn't score. But the fact that they made seven touchdowns was a major factor in the loss also. I don't know which was a bigger factor, but you take away them two things, and it would have been a tie. So, I'm real proud of our boys anyway.

ARLES: **(Pg 58)** I give up, Coach, take me out. So we're gonna say good night to ya . . . *(Musical transition)*

THURSTON: Good night!

ARLES: . . . And we'll see you tomorrow.

THURSTON: See you tomorrow.

ARLES: 'Til then, remember our motto here at Radio OKKK: If you can find someplace you like

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better than Tuna . . .

ARLES & THURSTON: MOVE!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2004 National Qualifier
2005 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
OH State Qualifier

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